

FIELDLINE BRIEFS

Battery Storage Zoning Watch

Ohio · Week 41 · Thursday, October 8, 2026 · Issue 12

THIS WEEK

Two local governments in our coverage area moved toward new battery storage rules this week, and two projects reached public review.

The item to watch is Tarrow County's proposed 12-month pause on battery storage zoning applications. Commissioners are scheduled to consider it on Tuesday, October 13, and as drafted it would take effect as soon as it is adopted.

5

ITEMS THIS WEEK

5

DATES COMING UP

7

SOURCES CHECKED

COMING UP

TUE, OCT 13 · 9:30 AM ET

Commissioners' session (public comment at the start): Tarrow County vote on a 12-month battery storage pause (Res. 2026-118)

FRI, OCT 16 · 4:00 PM ET

Written comments due to the Zoning Inspector: Wrenfield Township battery storage rules (ZTA-2026-03)

MON, OCT 19 · 7:00 PM ET

City council second reading: Marlowe Falls battery fire-safety ordinance (No. 2026-41)

WED, OCT 21 · 7:00 PM ET

Township zoning commission public hearing: Wrenfield Township battery storage rules (ZTA-2026-03)

THU, OCT 22 · 6:00 PM ET

Planning commission hearing and recommendation: Kessler Road battery project rezoning, Wrenfield Township (RZ-26-014)

Every date is also in the calendar file (.ics) sent with this issue. Times are Eastern Time.

TOP ITEM TARROW COUNTY · OCT 6, 2026

Tarrow County to consider a 12-month pause on battery storage zoning applications

Commissioners will take up Resolution 2026-118 at their October 13 regular session. It would stop the county from accepting or processing zoning permits, rezonings (zoning map amendments) and conditional use requests for battery energy storage facilities of 1 MW or more for 12 months.

It covers the areas under county zoning, currently Ferris, Quill and Brindle townships; townships that run their own zoning are not affected. Applications filed and found complete before it takes effect, and batteries that serve a single home or business on the same property, are excluded.

Why it matters: As drafted, the pause takes effect on the day it is adopted. The county zoning commission would then have nine months to recommend setback, fire-safety and decommissioning standards.

Resolution	2026-118
Covers	Battery storage facilities of 1 MW or more
Length	12 months from adoption, unless ended earlier

Commissioners' session (public comment at the start): Tue, Oct 13, 2026, 9:30 AM ET
Commissioners' Chambers, Tarrow County Administration Building, 41 Court Street, Tarrow City

Source: [Tarrow County Board of Commissioners, agenda for October 13, 2026 \(PDF\)](#), page 2, item 7

✓ Checked against the source on Oct 8, 2026

WRENFIELD TOWNSHIP, TARROW COUNTY · OCT 5, 2026

Wrenfield Township proposes battery storage rules: I-1 district only, 300-foot setbacks, removal bond

Zoning text amendment ZTA-2026-03 would add definitions for battery energy storage systems and allow battery energy storage facilities only as a conditional use in the I-1 Light Industrial district. It would require setbacks of at least 300 feet from existing homes and 100 feet from property lines, a decommissioning plan backed by a bond or letter of credit and reviewed every five years, and a fire-safety plan reviewed by the fire chief before a zoning certificate is issued.

Why it matters: Written comments close on October 16. After the October 21 hearing, the township zoning commission sends its recommendation to the township trustees.

Amendment	ZTA-2026-03
Setbacks	300 ft from existing homes, 100 ft from property lines
Where allowed	I-1 Light Industrial, as a conditional use

Written comments due to the Zoning Inspector: Fri, Oct 16, 2026, 4:00 PM ET

Township zoning commission public hearing: Wed, Oct 21, 2026, 7:00 PM ET
Wrenfield Township Hall, 8 Gable Road

Source: [Wrenfield Township, notice of public hearing on ZTA-2026-03 \(PDF\)](#), proposed amendments 1 to 5

✓ Checked against the source on Oct 8, 2026

REZONINGS AND APPLICATIONS · 2

WRENFIELD TOWNSHIP, TARROW COUNTY · OCT 5, 2026

48-acre rezoning sought for an 80 MW battery project on Kessler Road

Northbank Storage Partners LLC asks to rezone about 48.2 acres on the north side of Kessler Road from A-1 Agricultural to I-1 Light Industrial for a battery energy storage facility of about 80 MW / 320 MWh, as stated in the application (case RZ-26-014).

Why it matters: The Kestrel Regional Planning Commission holds the first public hearing and makes a recommendation on October 22. The township zoning commission then holds its own hearing before the township trustees decide. The same township is also considering the new battery storage rules above.

Case	RZ-26-014
Applicant	Northbank Storage Partners LLC
Size	About 80 MW / 320 MWh (per the application)
Zoning	A-1 Agricultural to I-1 Light Industrial

Planning commission hearing and recommendation: Thu, Oct 22, 2026, 6:00 PM ET
RPC Meeting Room, 210 Pike Street, Tarrow City

Source: [Kestrel Regional Planning Commission, agenda for October 22, 2026 \(PDF\)](#), page 1, item 3a; case summary on page 2

✓ Checked against the source on Oct 8, 2026

LARCH TOWNSHIP, HALDEN COUNTY · OCT 2, 2026

20 MW battery storage project files for a conditional use in Larch Township

Greyline Energy Storage LLC filed conditional use application CU-2026-031 on October 2 for "Larch Storage", a 20 MW battery energy storage facility on about 6.5 acres on the south side of Tolland Road, east of the Larch substation.

Why it matters: The county lists the application as received, with a Board of Zoning Appeals hearing still to be scheduled. We will add the hearing date when the county posts it.

Case	CU-2026-031
Applicant	Greyline Energy Storage LLC
Size	20 MW on about 6.5 acres
Status	Received; hearing to be scheduled

Source: [Halden County open data, zoning applications \(case CU-2026-031\)](#), case record

ORDINANCES · 1

CITY OF MARLOWE FALLS, HALDEN COUNTY · OCT 5, 2026

Marlowe Falls battery fire-safety ordinance amended ahead of its second reading

The Safety Committee amended Ordinance 2026-41 on October 5. As amended, it applies to battery energy storage systems larger than 600 kWh (up from 50 kWh), other than systems serving a single one- or two-family home. It requires compliance with NFPA 855, an emergency response plan approved by the fire chief before a certificate of occupancy is issued, a site walkthrough with the fire department once a year (down from twice a year) and a 24-hour emergency contact posted at each entrance.

Why it matters: Systems of 600 kWh or less would not be covered. City council holds the second reading on October 19.

City council second reading: Mon, Oct 19, 2026, 7:00 PM ET
Council Chambers, Marlowe Falls City Hall, 12 Main Street

Source: [City of Marlowe Falls, Ordinance 2026-41 as amended \(PDF\)](#), sections 1 to 5; committee amendments on page 2

✓ Checked against the source on Oct 8, 2026

How this brief is made

Each week we check 7 official sources (county commission agendas, planning commission packets, township legal notices, city legislation and county open data) for changes. A person reads every item against its source document before the brief is sent. We link to the official documents rather than copying them.

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